

BETNESONE-G CREAM

COMPOSITION

Betamethasone base (Micronised) (as Betamethasone-17-valerate BP)	0.1 % w/w
Gentamicin base (as Gentamicin Sulphate BP)	0.1 % w/w

PHARMACODYNAMICS

Gentamicin is an aminoglycoside antibiotic with bactericidal actions against many Gram-negative aerobes including *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*, *Proteus* species (indole-positive and indole-negative), *Escherichia coli*, *Klebsiella-Enterobacter-Serratia* species, *Citrobacter* species, and against *Staphylococcus* species (coagulase-positive and coagulase-negative). It acts by inhibiting normal protein synthesis in susceptible organisms. Enterococci, streptococci and anaerobes are resistant to gentamicin.

Betamethasone-17-valerate is a glucocorticoid with anti-inflammatory, anti-pruritic and vasoconstrictive actions.

PHARMACOKINETICS

In general, topically applied gentamicin is not absorbed systemically. However, systemic absorption of gentamicin and other aminoglycosides has been reported after topical use on denuded skin and burns.

Topical corticosteroids can be absorbed from normal intact skin. Absorption is increased when the skin is flamed, when it is applied over an extensive area or when occlusive dressing are used. After absorption from the skin, corticosteroids are metabolised mainly in the liver and excreted by the kidneys via pathways similar to systemically administered corticosteroids.

INDICATIONS

Treatment of allergic or inflammatory dermatoses complicated by secondary bacterial infections with a Gram-negative component.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

Apply a small amount of cream to the affected area twice daily, or as prescribed. In mild cases once daily application may suffice.

SIDE EFFECTS

In general, topically applied gentamicin is not absorbed systemically. Topical corticosteroids can be absorbed through the skin in sufficient amounts to cause systemic side effects including hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis suppression.

Local adverse reactions may include burning, itching, irritation, hypertrichosis, acneiform eruptions, hypopigmentation, allergic contact dermatitis, skin atrophy and striae. These reactions may occur more frequently if occlusive dressings are used.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Contraindicated in patients with known allergy or history of serious toxic reactions to gentamicin or other aminoglycosides, or to any of the components in the preparation.

OVERDOSAGE

Excessive prolonged use of topical corticosteroids can cause systemic side-effects particularly in children. If hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis suppression is noted, attempt should be made to withdraw the drug or reduce the frequency of application.

PRECAUTIONS

Betnesone-G Cream is for external use only. It should not be used in patients with tuberculosis of the skin, herpes simplex, vaccinia or varicella. Avoid contact with the eyes.

Since gentamicin is not effective against fungi, patients with superficial fungus or yeast infections must also receive specific antifungal therapy.

Topical corticosteroids can be absorbed through the skin in sufficient amounts to cause systemic side effects, particularly when the preparation is applied over a large surface area, when use is prolonged or when occlusive dressings are used.

Safety of topical corticosteroids in pregnant women has not been established. Therefore, topical corticosteroids should not be used extensively in pregnant patients, in large amounts or for prolonged periods of time.

Prolonged use of topical antibiotic may cause superinfection with resistant organisms such as fungi.

WARNING

Use of topical gentamicin in closed hospital settings is actively discouraged.

SHELF LIFE

4 years

STORAGE CONDITIONS

Store below 30°C.

Keep container tightly closed.

Protect from light.

PRESENTATION

Tubes of 5, 10 or 15g

MANUFACTURED BY:
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